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Ohio River Trail Council

"Joining communities through fitness, recreation, heritage and transportation networks"

January 21, 2014

Re: Ohio River Trail Council Supports the Beaver County, Pennsylvania Brownfield Assessment Coalition Grant Application

Dear Beaver County, Monaca Borough, Moon Township & U.S. EPA Officials:

I write on behalf of the Ohio River Trail Council to convey our ardent support for the Beaver County PA / Ohio River Brownfields Coalition effort to revitalize brownfields along the Ohio River and other sites in our region. Our organization encourages the EPA to deliver Beaver County the requested \$600,000 in grant resources for these revitalization efforts, and the Ohio River Trail Council intends to participate in the implementation if Beaver County is funded.

In order to ensure an optimistic outlook for our waterways, forests, and towns, the Ohio River Trail Council mission is to bring individuals, groups, communities, businesses, and all levels of government together to honor our past and build our future by providing recreation opportunities, heritage preservation, environmental stewardship, brownfield remediation, active transportation networks, and economic development along the Ohio River and its tributaries. It is our goal that the Ohio River Trail function as a framework for redevelopment. In addition, as a tool for ecology and the environment, the Ohio River Trail will preserve natural landscape, safeguard wildlife diversity, and provide vital habitat corridors offering possibilities for birding, butterflying, deer spotting, fishing or enjoying the spring wildflowers or the peak autumn colors.

The Ohio River Trail Council is committed to the Ohio River Brownfields Coalition effort and the EPA grant. If the EPA funding is furnished and initiates the process for the recovery of the brownfields, the Ohio River Trail Council will remain supportive as the Ohio River Trail project, which includes both the Ohio River Greenway Trail and the Ohio River Water Trail, is contingent upon the complete and successful restoration of these industrial sites. The Ohio River Trail Council enthusiastically endorses the grant application for both the Beaver County and Allegheny County locations because the planned Ohio River Trail interconnects and passes through all of these targeted brownfields. As an example, the renovated parcel that will become the Moon Township Riverfront Park will serve as a dual trailhead for both the Ohio River Greenway Trail and the Ohio River Water Trail.

We urge the EPA to bestow the Ohio River Brownfields Coalition with this much needed capital, and thank you in advance for your consideration.

Respectfully submitted,

Dr. Vincent Troia

Dr. Vincent Troia, Executive Chairman
Ohio River Trail Council